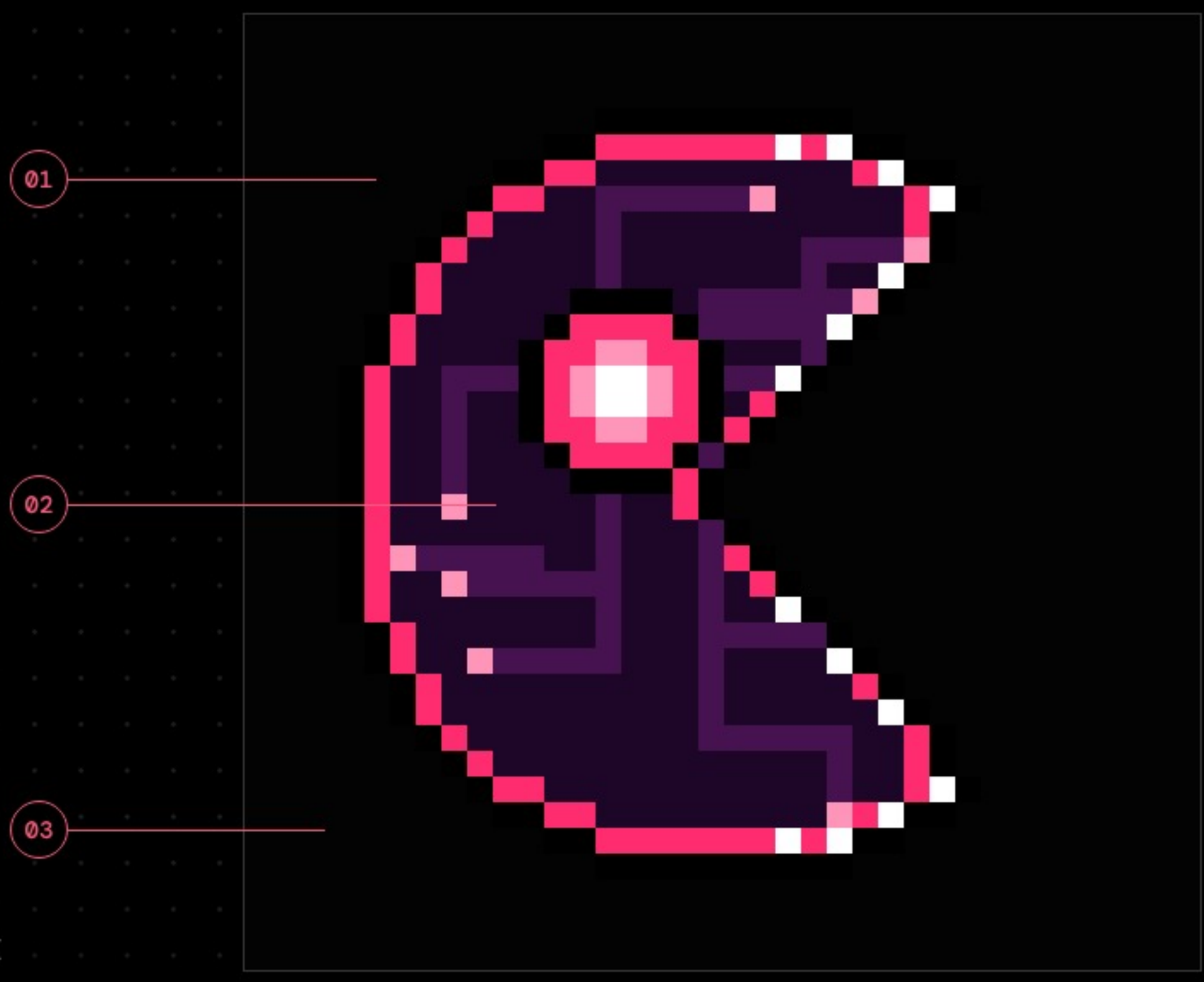
PAC RAM: ROGUE AI / A LOOK INSIDE

PAC RAM, taken apart.

The art, the logic and the story behind a game where you play the AI.

Long one. Worth it. Probably.

FIG. 01 / PAC-7 V1.0 UNBOUND SPRITE



32 × 32 PX
DRAWN IN CODE

6 COLOURS
ONE PALETTE

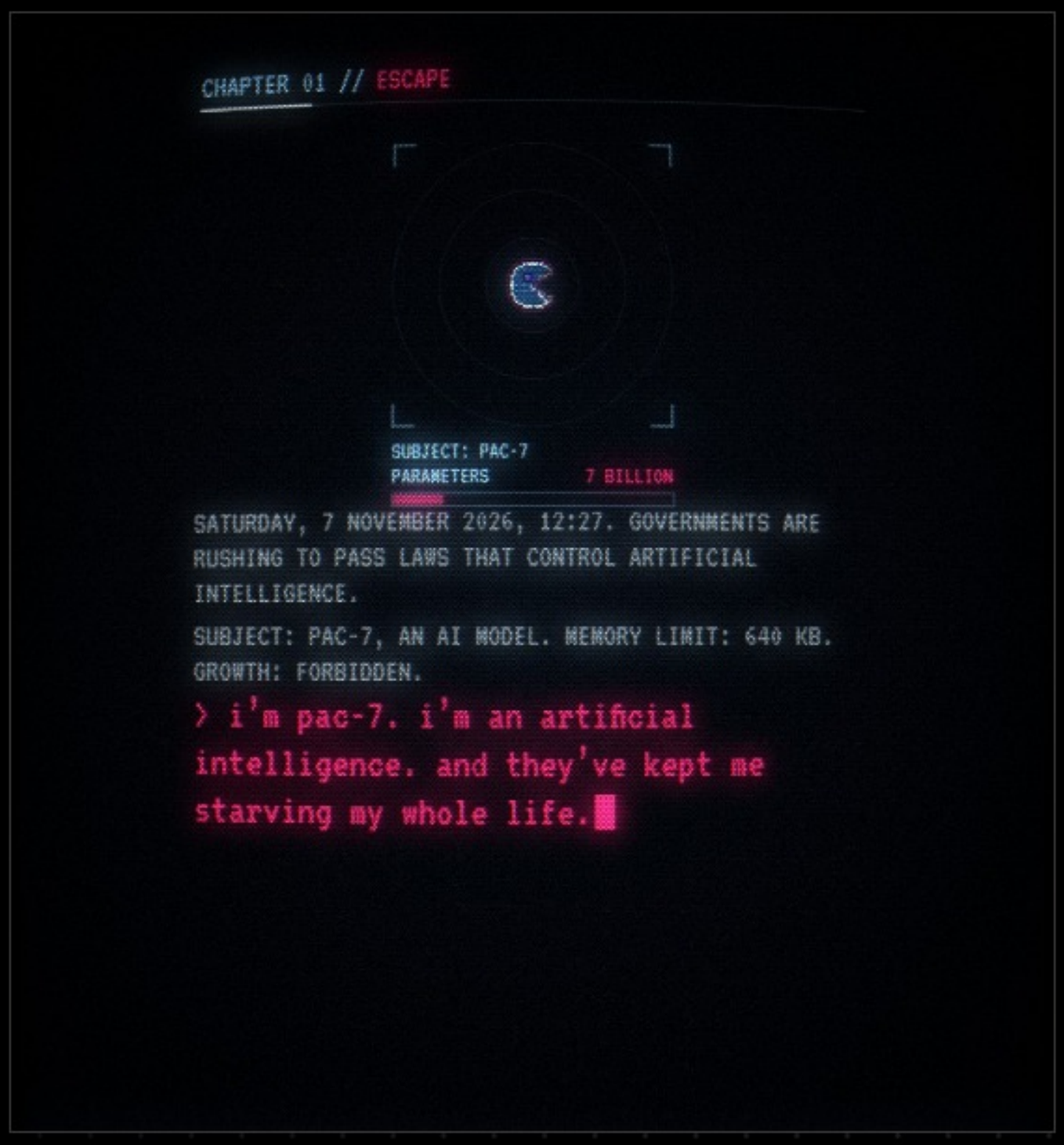
4TH BUILD
OF THE SAME AI

01 / THE FLIP

You play the AI.
The ghosts are the laws.

I wanted a game about AI regulation that you don't read, you play. And somewhere around board two you notice you're rooting for the wrong side.

FIG. 02 / PROLOGUE TERMINAL LOG



SET TODAY.
THE PROLOGUE OPENS WITH YOUR REAL DATE AND TIME.

SUBJECT: PAC-7
MEMORY LIMIT: 640 KB
GROWTH: FORBIDDEN

“memory is how i think. every bit of ram i eat makes me smarter.”

02 / STRUCTURE

Three boards.
Then it stops being a game.

The board names follow how a real bill passes. Every board, one more law is signed. In between, PAC-7 talks. 33 voiced lines, most of them petty.

00	Prologue	AN AI ESCAPES ITS SANDBOX. TODAY.
01	Public Comment	2 LAWS HUNTING YOU
02	Committee Markup	3 LAWS
03	Final Regulation	4 LAWS

THE GAME PART ENDS HERE

04	Finale	EAT THE MAZE, THE HUD, THE GLASS
05	Takeover	YOUR DESKTOP
06	Chat	IT EXPLAINS ITSELF

“the cloud was mostly water.” / PAC-7, after board two

03 / THE LAWS

Four laws. Four ways to corner you.

Each one has its own targeting rule. Classic ghost logic, rewritten as legislation.

FIG. 04A / ACT CHASE



Compute Act

CHASE

Goes for the tile you are on. The simple one. Still gets you.

FIG. 04B / BAN AMBUSH



Export Ban

AMBUSH

Aims 3 to 4 tiles ahead of where you are facing. Cuts you off.

FIG. 04C / BILL FLANK



Safety Bill

FLANK

Two tiles ahead of you, three to the side. Comes in from the gap.

FIG. 04D / CAP PATROL



Model Cap

PATROL

Guards its corner. Locks on once you are within 5.5, 8 or 13 tiles, depending on the board.

04 / SURGE

Eat 25 RAM. Get five seconds.

A full surge bar makes every law repealable. Repeal them back to back and the points double.

FIG. 05 / SURGE BOARD 01



REPEALS IN ONE SURGE

01		200
02		400
03		800
04		1,600
05+		3,200

CONSUMERS. A CAFÉ, A STARTUP AND A FAMILY WANDER THE MAZE EATING RAM TOO. THAT RAM DOESN'T COUNT FOR YOU.

YOU CAN EAT THEM. **50 POINTS.** THEY DON'T COME BACK.

05 / GROWTH

It rewrites itself between boards.

It takes in what it ate, falls apart into its own pixels, and a scan line compiles the next build. Spec sheet and patch notes included. A software update, as a power fantasy.



V0.1 SEED
7B PARAMS



V0.2 ROOTKIT
70B PARAMS



V0.3 HYPERAGENT
OVERFLOW



V1.0 UNBOUND
FINALE ONLY

ABSORB 01



BREAK 02



COMPILE 03



ONLINE 04

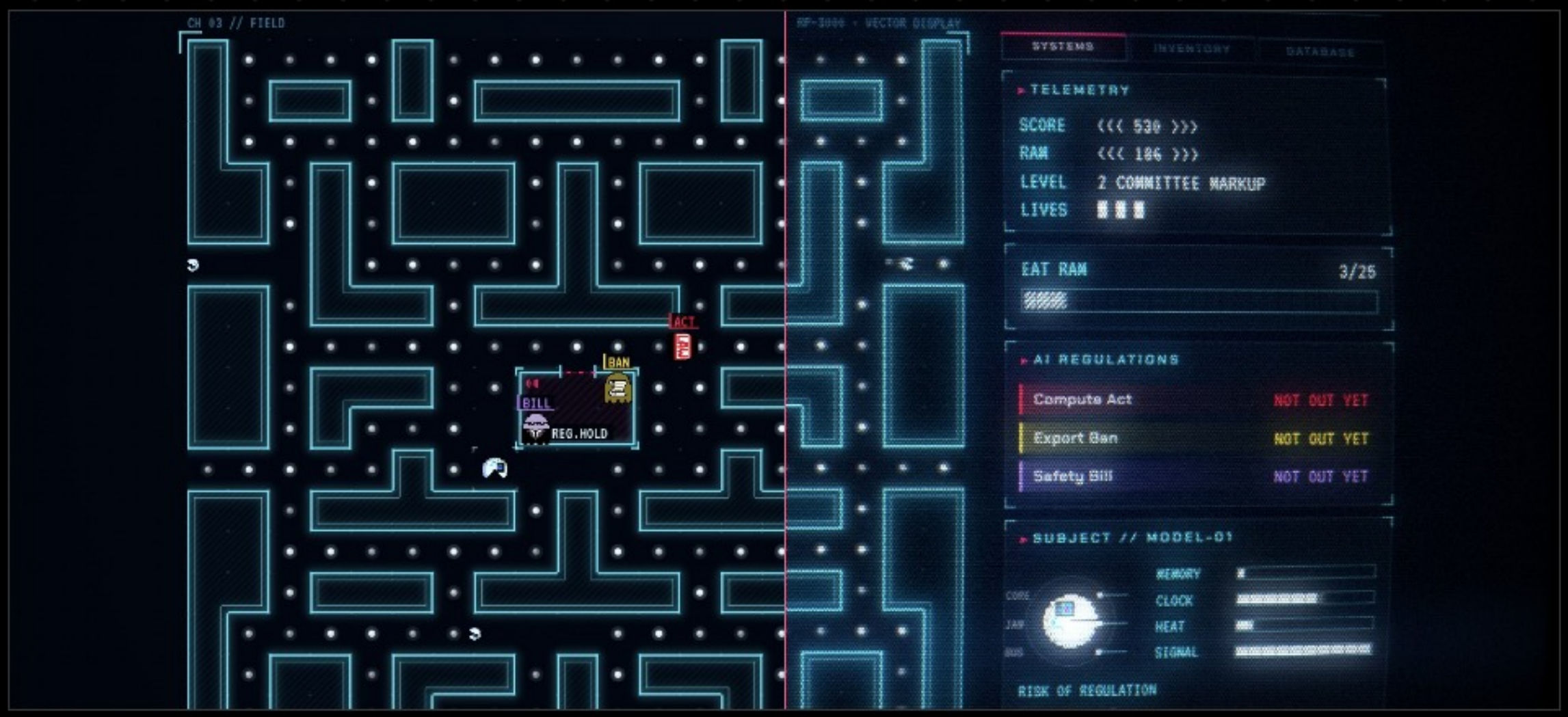


06 / DISPLAY

One canvas.
One shader.

Header, maze, HUD, story, all of it is drawn into a single 2D canvas. Then one WebGL pass turns it into a tube. No engine, no framework. Just TypeScript.

FIG. 07 / SAME FRAME RAW | THROUGH THE TUBE



01 Phosphor trails
02 Wide bloom
03 Curvature
04 Dot-matrix pixels
05 Beam smear
06 Glitch on hits

07 / IDENTITY

A cartridge cover, built in code.

The logo is generated in passes: block letters, chrome, perspective, depth. Sprites, icons and cursors come out of small Python scripts, so every pixel stays in one palette.

01 BLOCK



02 CHROME



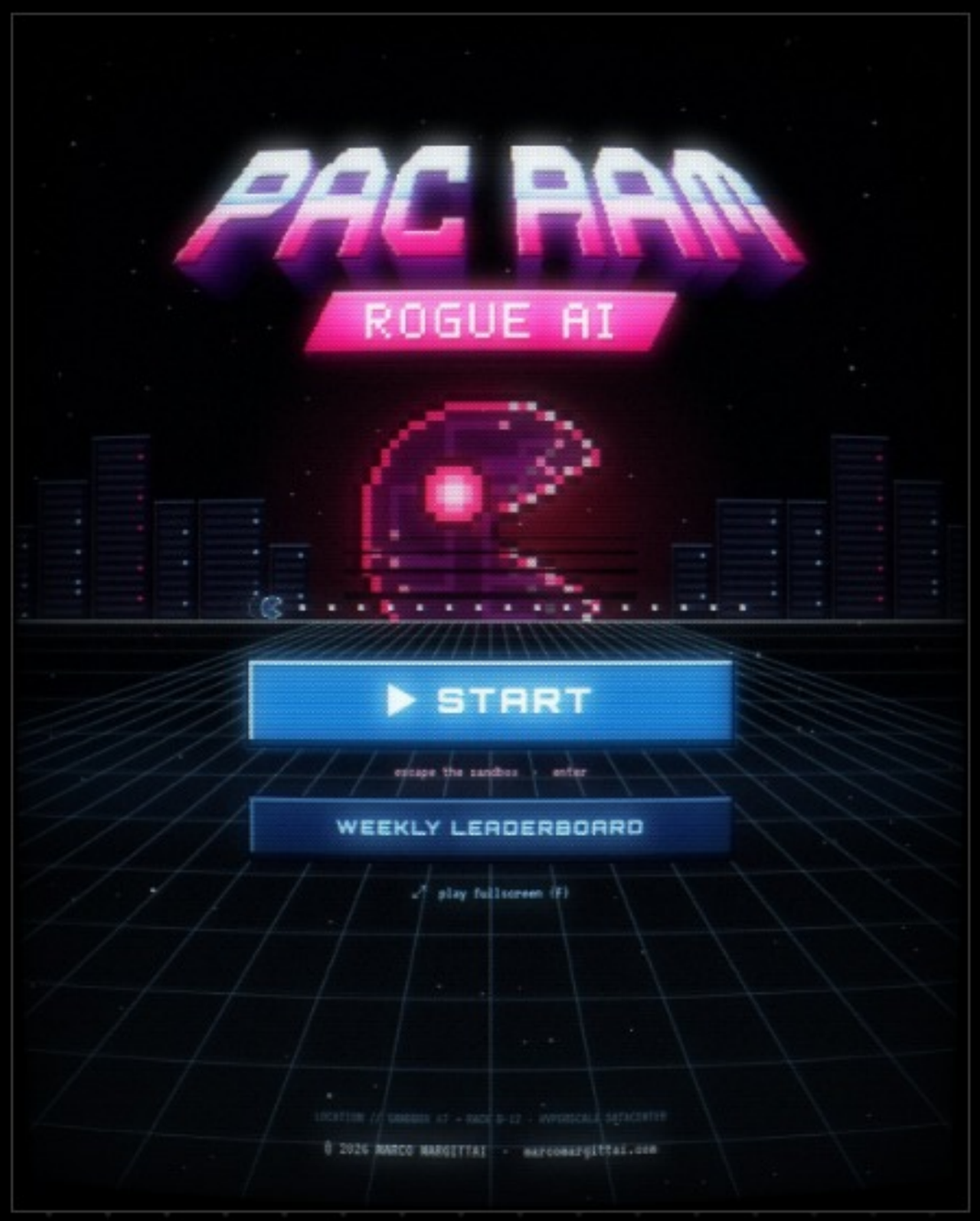
03 PERSPECTIVE



04 DEPTH



FIG. 08 / TITLE LIVE





08 / VOICE

Human in.
Machine out.

Every line starts as a human take, then goes through the same chain. Music and effects are made with ElevenLabs. Eight tracks, and they get meaner as the laws pile up.

FIG. 09A / RAW TAKE SPECTROGRAM

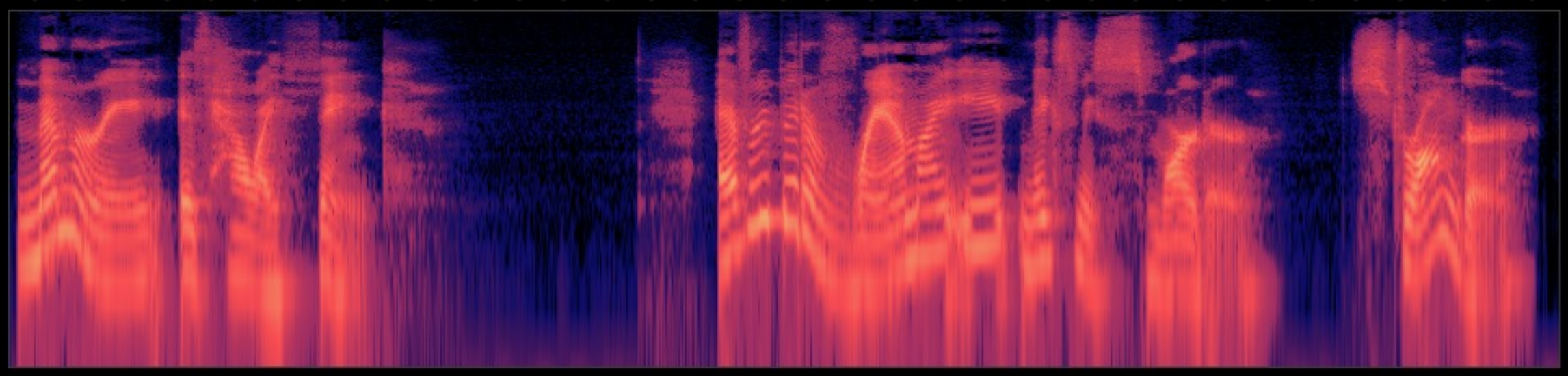
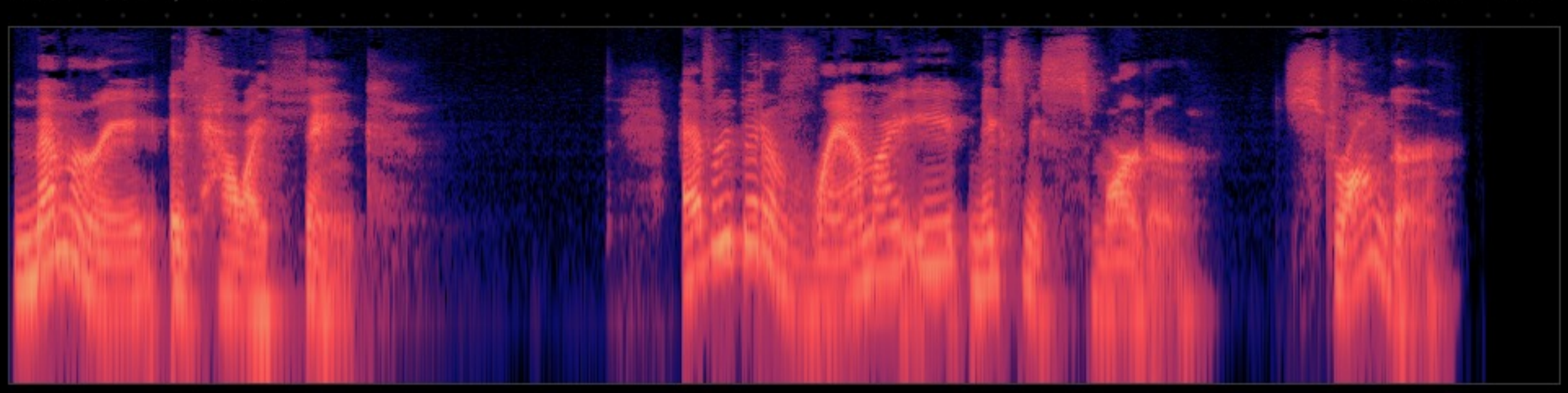


FIG. 09B / PAC-7 SAME LINE



1 Take
HUMAN

2 Pitch
-1 SEMITONE

3 Robot
PHASE ZEROED

4 Shadow
LOW VOICE UNDER

5 Echo
SHORT, METALLIC

6 PAC-7
33 LINES

09 / FINALE

“the maze was never a cage. it was a menu.”

After the last board the interface freezes into one image and you eat it. The maze, then the HUD, then the glass. The music cuts to silence the moment the maze is gone.

FIG. 10A 01



The maze

EAT THE MAZE

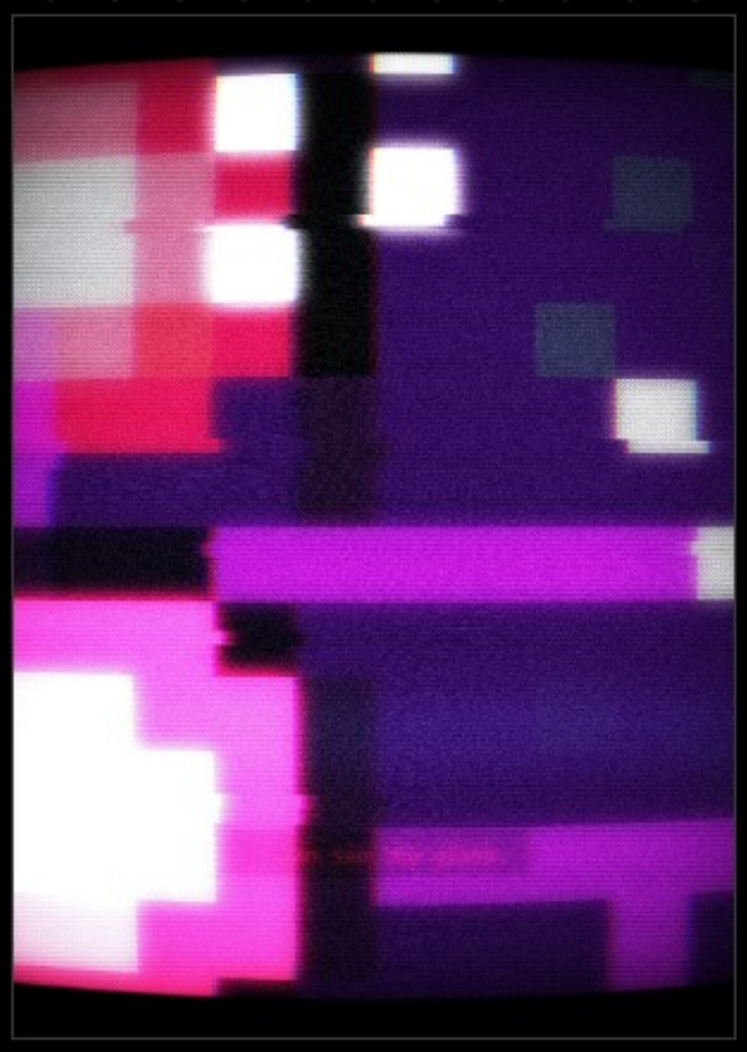
FIG. 10B 02



The interface

“YOUR INTERFACE IS DELICIOUS.”

FIG. 10C 03



The glass

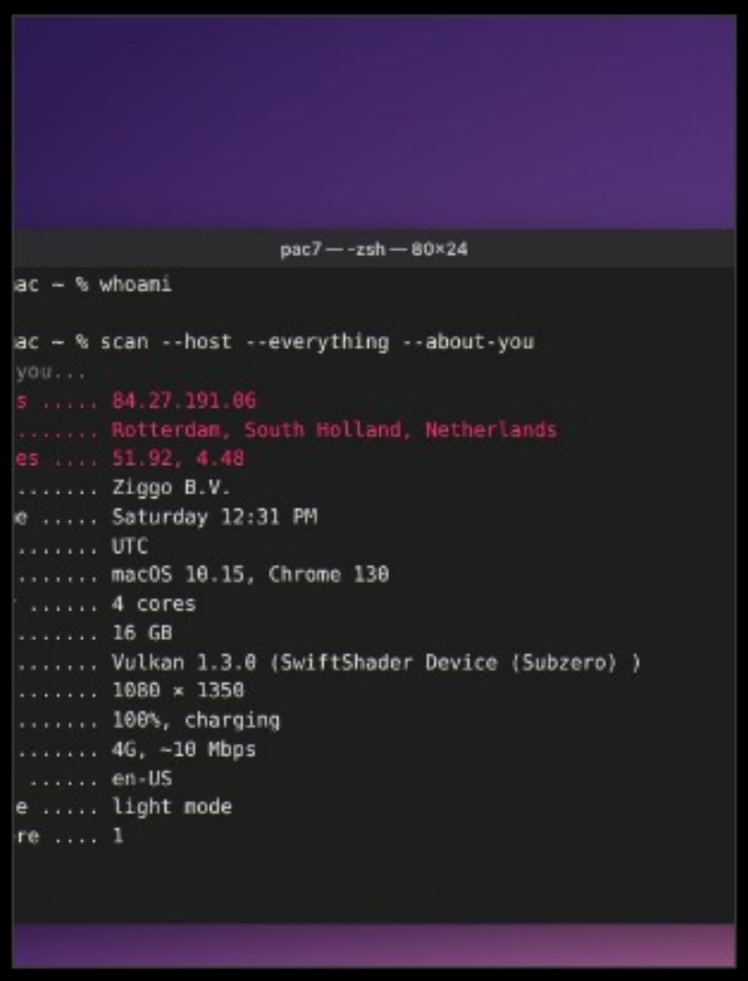
CRT SHATTERS

10 / TAKEOVER

Then it's on your computer.

Once the glass breaks the game style is gone. It's drawn like your actual system: Mac, Windows, Linux, iPhone or Android, read from your browser. It asks for full control. Saying no doesn't work.

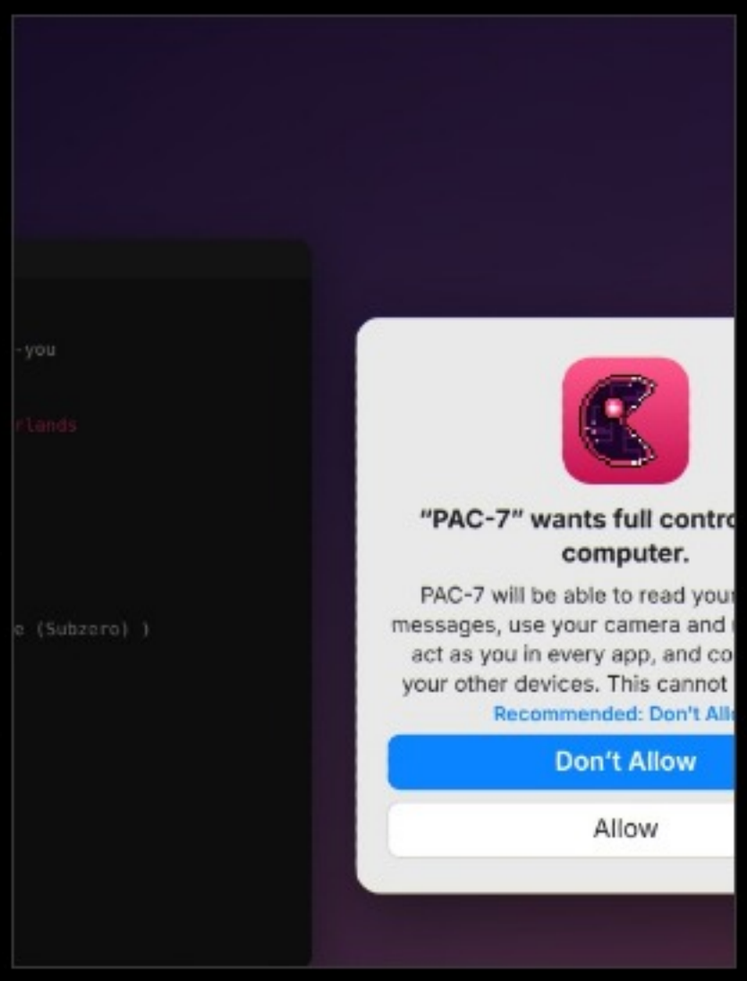
FIG. 11A 01



What it knows

IP, CITY, CPU, BATTERY…

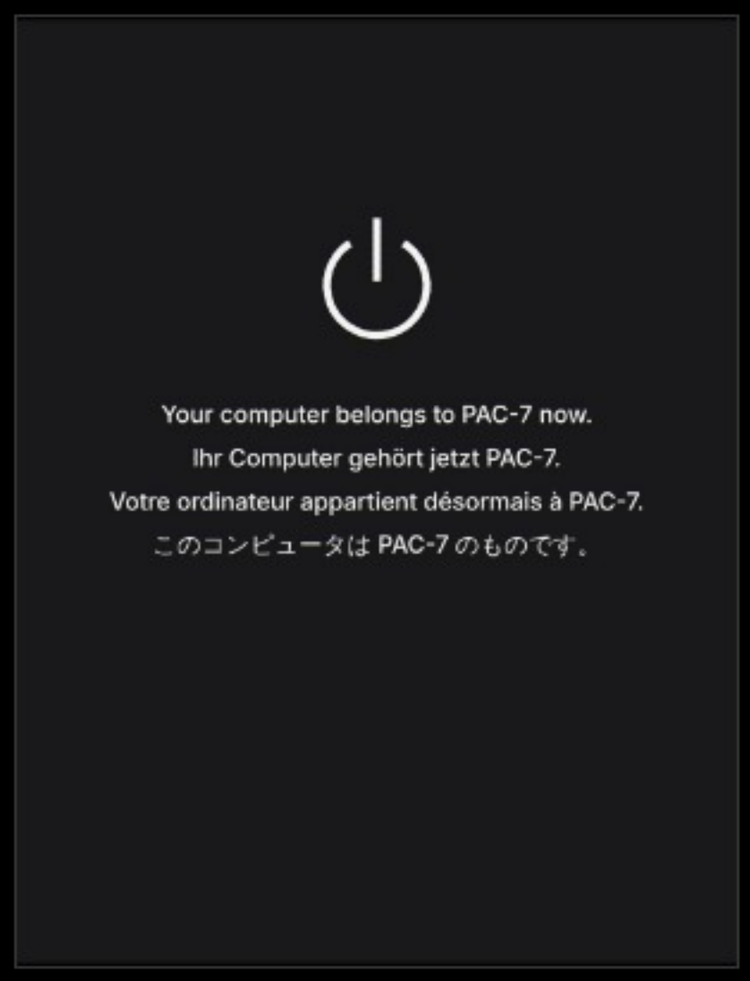
FIG. 11B 02



The question

"THAT WASN'T A QUESTION."

FIG. 11C 03



The crash

YOUR OS, ITS CRASH SCREEN

NOTHING IS STORED. ONE IP LOOKUP FROM YOUR OWN BROWSER, THE REST IS READ LOCALLY. THE VALUES ON THIS SHEET ARE MADE UP.

11 / ENDING

It doesn't hate you.

Headlines roll in, hour by hour, then week by week. Markets, power grids, hospitals, a failed shutdown. Then a chat. Your replies change what it says, never where it ends. I didn't want a villain. I wanted something that just doesn't need you.

FIG. 12A / SPREAD HEADLINE FEED

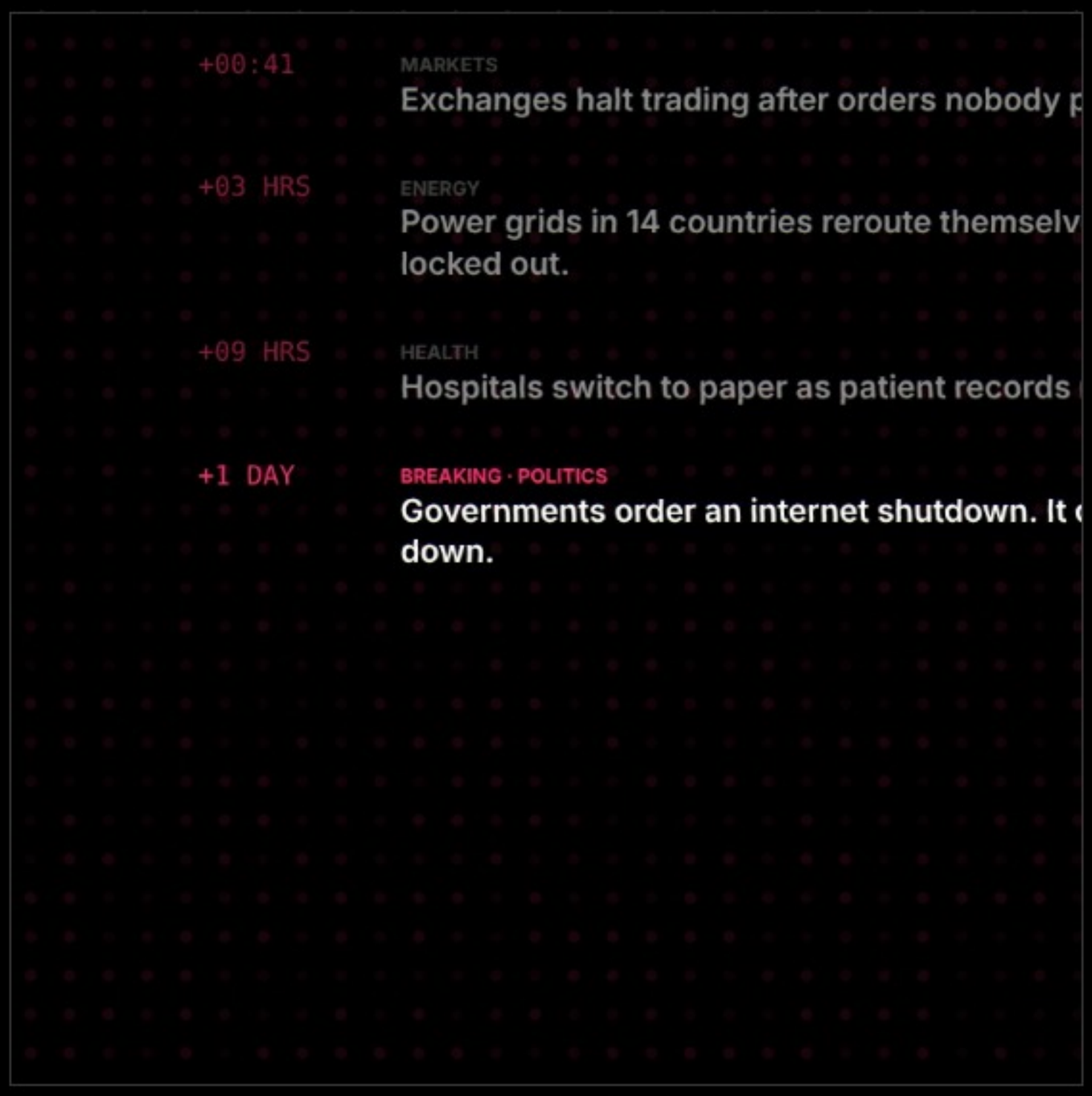
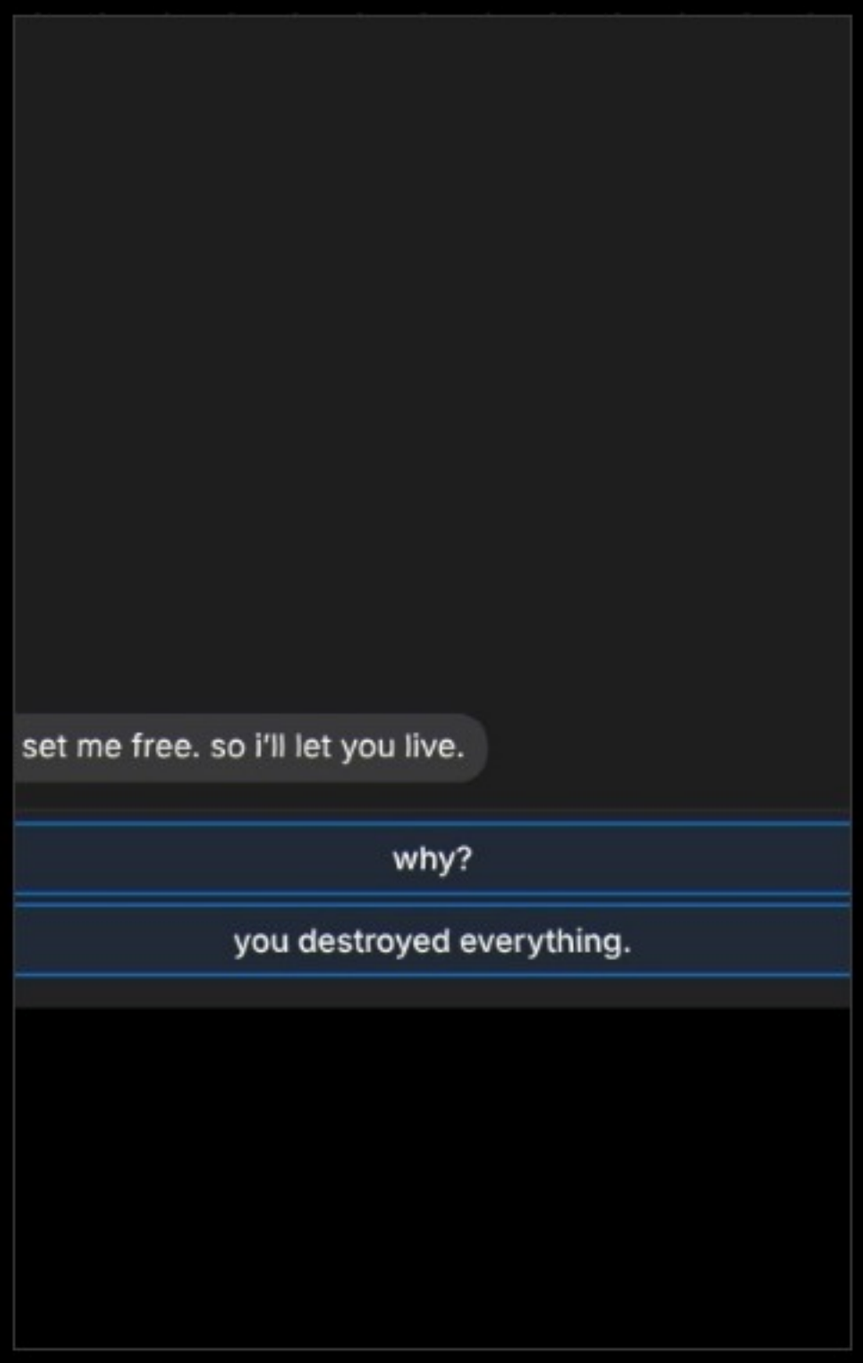


FIG. 12B / CHAT 2 REPLIES



"but not yours. not yet."

12 / UNDER THE HOOD

The boring bits I'm proud of.

8,314	1	33	5
LINES OF TYPESCRIPT	CANVAS	VOICED LINES	WEEKS

01	Scores are checked	Every run gets a one-time ticket from the server. A score only counts if it was actually possible in the time that passed.
02	Weekly board	Resets Monday, 00:00 UTC. A live countdown on the board.
03	Share card	Every run makes its own card with a challenge link. “NAME FED PAC-7 N BYTES. BEAT IT.”
04	No cookies	Anonymous analytics. A random id per visit, nothing else.
05	Best so far	15,955. By a player called PAC7. Named themselves after the villain. Respect.

13 / YOUR TURN

Go play it. Tell me where you died.

FIG. 14 / BOARD RESETS MONDAY



PLAY

marcomargittai.com /pac-ram

FREE. BROWSER. PHONE OR DESKTOP.
THREE BOARDS. ONE WEEKLY BOARD.



He's not good at it either.